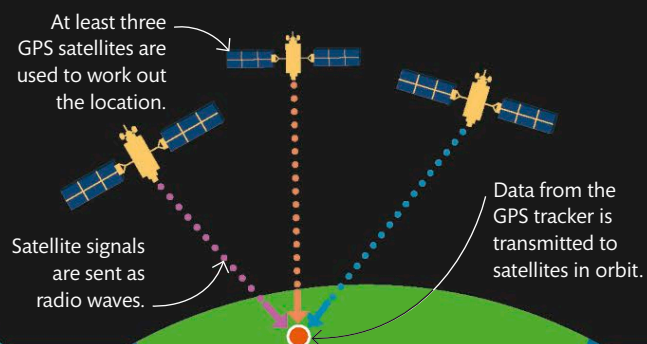




Radio tags run on long-lasting batteries, and some are even solar-powered.

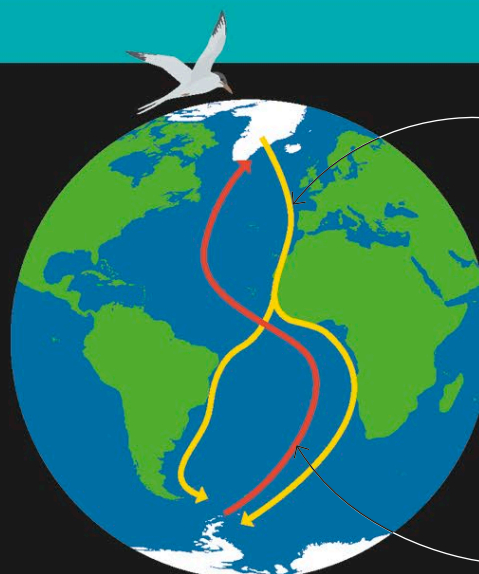
GPS

One of the ways animals are tracked is by using a system called GPS (Global Positioning System). Once a bird is fitted with a GPS tracker, the device sends data about its location to GPS satellites in orbit around Earth. There are about 30 in total. These satellites use the information to pinpoint the bird's precise location.



Migration routes

GPS allows scientists to track migrations across the world. Arctic terns have the longest migration of all animals. These birds cover an incredible distance of about 60,000 miles (96,000 km) every year to breed in the Arctic in summer. After this, they fly to the southern polar region to rest and feed in Antarctica.



Arctic terns fly south along the coastlines of Africa and South America.

While flying back to the north, the birds take a route that is away from the coastlines.